

ELI — Common Errors and Fixes

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A quick reference for the gremlins that actually come up when running ELI. Each one is symptom → cause → the exact fix. Add new ones as they surface.

Clicking a link opens no browser page

Symptom: the server prints the URLs fine and copy-paste works, but Ctrl/right-click → "Open Link" opens nothing. **Cause:** broken **snap Firefox** — a mesa-2404 auto-refresh leaves Firefox's GPU content-mount stale (/snap/firefox/.../gpu-2404-provider-wrapper goes missing), so *launching* a fresh Firefox fails silently while an already-open window still works. **Fix:**

```
killall -9 firefox
sudo snap disconnect firefox:gpu-2404
sudo snap connect firefox:gpu-2404 mesa-2404:gpu-2404
# if it's still stuck:
sudo snap refresh firefox
sudo snap refresh mesa-2404
```

Reopen Firefox once, then relaunch the server — clicks (and the auto-open) work again.

Wrong / tiny model loads instead of your usual one

Symptom: ELI boots on a small model (e.g. tinyllama-1B) even though settings point at your 35B A3B. **Cause:** a stray ELI_GGUF_MODEL_PATH / ELI_MODEL_PATH env var in your shell **overrides config** (it wins over everything). **Fix:**

```
echo $ELI_GGUF_MODEL_PATH          # if this prints a model path, that's the culprit
unset ELI_GGUF_MODEL_PATH ELI_MODEL_PATH
```

Or just switch live from the dashboard: **Settings → Model**.

Server won't start / "address already in use"

Cause: a previous instance is still bound to the port. **Fix:**

```
kill -f "api/server.py" # or find it: ss -ltnp | grep 8081
```

Then relaunch. ELI's web port is **8081**, HTTPS **8443**.

Phone can't connect after a restart

Symptom: a paired phone gets 401 / "can't access the server." **Cause:** it's carrying an old token (server restarted, or you rotated the token). **Fix:** the token now **persists** across restarts — just re-open the current link/QR from the **Connect** tab. To deliberately kick a lost phone off, hit **rotate** and re-pair.

Phone can't connect at all (fresh pairing)

Cause: the firewall is blocking the port. **Fix:** run the exact `sudo ufw allow ...` lines the server prints on startup, and make sure the phone is on the **same Wi-Fi**.

Phone microphone / voice doesn't work

Cause: browsers block the mic (`getUserMedia`) on a plain `http://LAN-IP` page. **Fix:** start with `--https` and open the `https://...:8443/` link on the phone; accept the one-time self-signed "not private" warning.

Model dropdown in the dashboard is empty

Cause: the list endpoint was being shadowed by the OpenAI-compatible `/v1/models` route. **Fix:** already fixed — the list lives at `/v1/models/installed`. If a fork regresses it, make sure the dashboard fetches that path, not `/v1/models`.

News shows old stories as "the latest"

Cause: the interest-matched half wasn't recency-gated. **Fix:** already fixed (a freshness gate drops stale niche matches). If it recurs, say refresh the news.

Terminal shows escape-code junk around a URL (`^[ ]8; ;...`)

Cause: you're looking at a **log file** or `cat -v` output — those *always* render raw escape codes. A live terminal renders the link normally. Not a bug.

git push → "Could not resolve host github.com"

Cause: a transient DNS/network blip (ELI is offline-by-default, but git is separate). **Fix:** just retry the push.

Vision / CLIP segfaults on the GPU

Cause: the CLIP/vision path can segfault on some GPUs. **Fix:** CLIP runs on **CPU** by design; keep it there. Main-model + vision hot-swap handle VRAM automatically — don't force CLIP onto the GPU.

*House rule: when a new error bites, add it here — symptom, cause, and the **exact** commands that fixed it. Future-you will thank present-you.*